

E. Sreedharan: The "Metro Man" of India

E. Sreedharan is a renowned Indian civil engineer and a retired member of the Indian Engineering Services (IES). He is widely celebrated as the "**Metro Man**" for his transformative contributions to India's public transport infrastructure. Known as the father of 21st-century infrastructure creation in India, he has built a reputation for delivering massive projects on time and within budget.

Personal Background

- **Birth:** Born on June 12, 1932, in Karukaputhur, Palakkad district, Kerala.
 - **Education:** * Attended BEM High School and Victoria College in Palakkad, where he was classmates with T.N. Seshan.
 - Graduated in Civil Engineering from the Government Engineering College, Kakinada (now known as JNTU Kakinada).
 - **Age:** He is 85 years old (as of the document's drafting).
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Career Highlights

Sreedharan's career began as a lecturer at the Government Polytechnic in Kozhikode and an apprentice at the Bombay Port Trust before he joined the IES.

- **Pamban Bridge Restoration:** In 1964, after a cyclone destroyed parts of the bridge, he restored it in just **46 days**, far exceeding the three-month target set by his superiors.
 - **Major Projects:**
 - **Konkan Railway:** Completed in seven years.
 - **Delhi Metro:** Established India's first modern metro system.
 - **Kochi Metro:** Oversaw completion in just four years.
 - **Current & Advisory Roles:** He has served as the Chief Advisor for the Lucknow Metro and is involved in upcoming projects in Jaipur, Visakhapatnam, Vijayawada, and Coimbatore.
 - **Global Impact:** Appointed by UN Secretary-General Ban Ki-moon to the High-Level Advisory Group on Sustainable Transport for a three-year term.
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Awards and Recognition

- **Padma Shri:** 2001.
- **TIME Magazine Asia's Heroes:** 2003.
- **Chevalier de la Légion d'honneur:** (French Government) 2005.
- **Padma Vibhushan:** 2008.
- **Railway Minister's Award:** For the Pamban Bridge achievement.
- **Note:** He was also considered a choice for the 2017 presidential candidate selection.

Philosophy for Success

Sreedharan attributes his success to a core set of values:

- **Integrity and Teamwork:** Maintaining high team morale and ethics.
- **Accountability:** Providing service with social responsibility and strict punctuality.
- **Competence:** Combining professional skill with being a "virtuous doer"